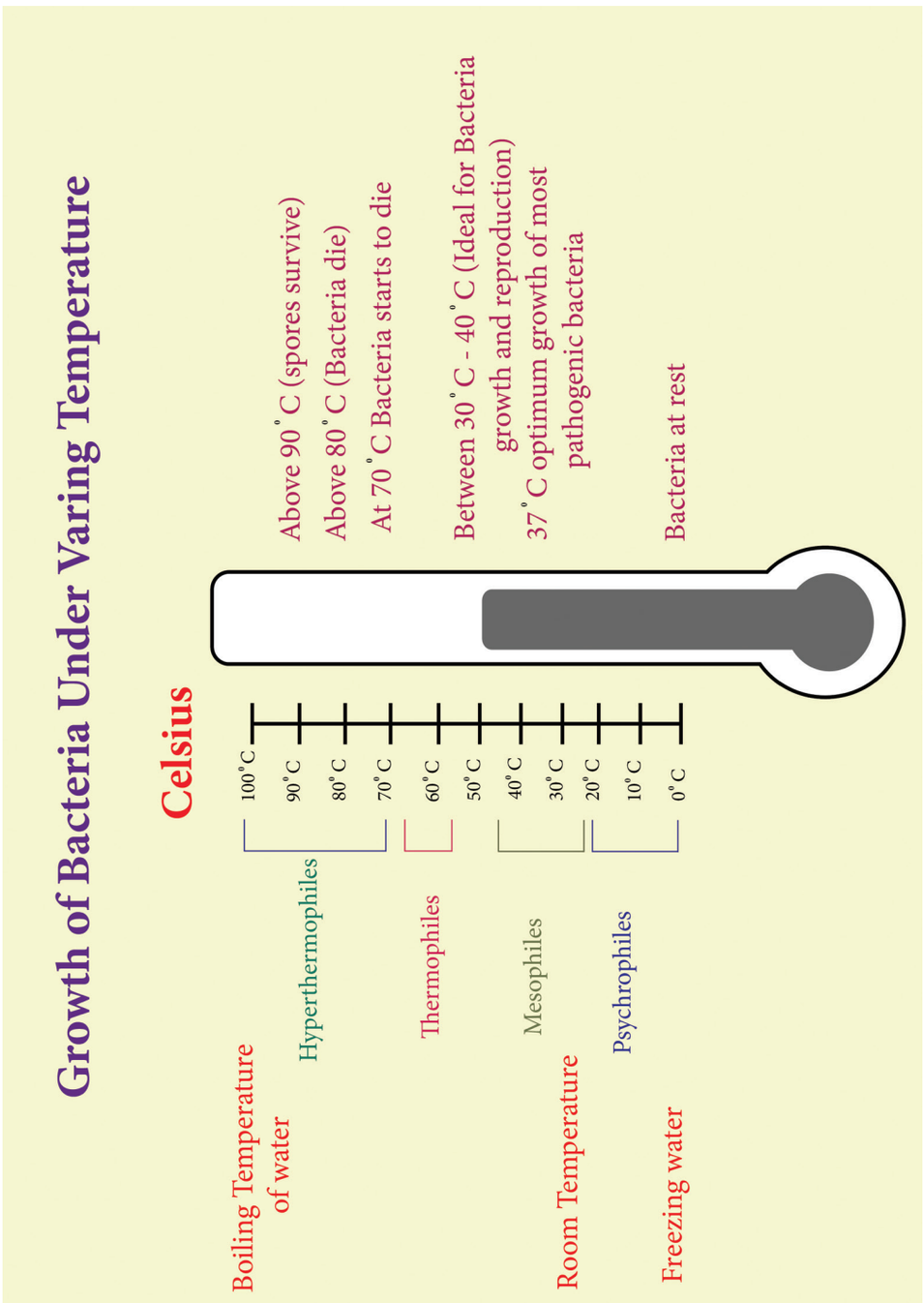
### Spread plate method

In this method, a known volume of the culture (0.1ml) is plated and spread over solidified sterile agar medium, using a sterile spreader. The total number of colonies appearing on the plate after incubation represents the total number of viable cells in the culture.

## 3. Measurement of Cell Mass

A cell suspension appears turbid or cloudy due to active cell growth. When light is passed through this cell suspension, microbial cells scatter light striking them. As the concentration of cells and turbidity increases, more light is scattered and less light is transmitted through the suspension. The amount of unscattered light can be measured using a spectrophotometer, the values of which are indirectly related to cell numbers.






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